Milestone 1 for Catalyst Proposal #1100249 Daniel Roa

Adaptation of Catalyst Ecosystem to Decentralized Governance through the Council System

Conceptual Framework

Color guide:

Core Governance Subject | Researched Texts | Key Concepts | Corresponding Catalyst competence | Yet to be solved

: number page*

Hannah Arendts Critic

Arendt signals that there is a conflict between the federational model and centralised power in traditional governance

In fact, in Arendt's terms, laws in general and international law in particular are not commandments, as we have come to think of them as inheritors of biblical and natural law traditions. This are ideas without a a revision but installed by tradition.

This section should focus in the main critics that common democracies commit and that should be avoided in Catalyst using the Council System

Arendt agrees with the traditional critics of democracy

The few and the many as a traditional separation and the relations that happen between them.

What is the rift between philosophy and politics that can be traced back to plato

"the new phenomenon of the masses and the transformation of the state into an instrument of the nation"

By "democracy" Renner means the "bourgeois," constitutional democracy, and the contrast he draws is with the more radical, "economic" democracy that the councils could promote, and which was supposed "to take over from purely political democracy."

:209

Why in the reconstitution of the state the new state reconstituided, does not solve the Origin and Legality of its Origin. The problem for arendt is the centralisation of power creatin a extremely problematic institution.

" the modern state was a strong state which through its growing tendency towards centralisation, monopolised the whole political life"

:209

Hannah Arendt. Aproaches to the german problem , essays on understanding

"The truth was that the national state, once the very symbol of the soverenty of the people, no longer represented the people, becoming incapable of safeguarding either its external or internal security."

Hannah Arendt. The nation in essays in understanding :207

Hannah Arendt. The aftermat of the nazi rule, report from germany in essay and understanding.

Hannah Arendt, On Violence

The first one is from the 1969 essay "On Violence." The main cause for wars in our time, Arendt writes in this essay, "is neither a secret death wish of the human species, nor an irrepressible instinct of aggression, nor, finally… the serious economic and social dangers inherent in disarmament, but the simple fact that no substitute for this final arbiter in international affairs has yet appeared on the political scene." Such substitute would not appear, in Arendt's view, as long as "national independence, namely, freedom from foreign rule, and the sovereignty of the state, namely, the claim to unchecked and unlimited power in foreign affairs, are identified." We find here a remarkable consistency by Arendt from her early to her late reflections on the international order: the principle of sovereignty has to be renounced if the problem of war is to be eliminated or at least mitigated.

Andrew arato and Jean Cohen;s essay on Arendt's critique of soverenty

What is the Arendts, critic of a Country's soverenty and its relation to war? :21

Lederman, Shmuel. (2019). Hannah Arendt and Participatory Democracy: A People's Utopia. 10.1007/978-3-030-11692-7.

In fact, in Arendt's terms, laws in general and international law in particular are not commandments, as we have come to think of them as inheritors of biblical and natural law traditions.

For arendt, what is the meaning of "Maieutic" for Arendt?

For arendt, what is the meaning of "Dokei Moi" for Arendt?

What is the meaning of "Dialegesthai" for Arendt?

What is the meaning of "Phronesis" for Arendt?

System of reexamination of opinion if there is contra diction:117 The notion of common sense with critical reasoning and what is communicable?

:74-75

The Arendtian public sphere (chapter :47)

For arendt, What is the difference between work and what is Labor?

What is the meaning of "Vita Activa" for Arendt?

The Human condition, Hannah Arendt

Philosophy and politics Arendt

What is the meaning of "Homo Faber" for Arendt?

Disch, "How Could Hannah Arendt," 352–353

The Modus of Deliberation for the Council System (Praxis)

What is the d distinction between delegation and representation

What are the concepts taken from Kant in the Judgment theory of Arendt? :104-112

Lederman, Shmuel. (2019). Hannah Arendt and Participatory Democracy: A People's Utopia. 10.1007/978-3-030-11692-7.

"In other words, that speech and action in the public sphere with our fellow citizens are ends in themselves rather than only means to other ends" (:Preface)

Arendt's greatest contribution to political theory is arguably her conceptualization of the public sphere as a "space of appearances," in which participants reveal who they are through speech and action, jointly generate power and experience political freedom.

Though in general and political thought comming from real world experiences

The "space of appearances"

What are the limits of the space of apearences?

Relationship

The concept of : From the vita activa to the vita contemplativa

What is Eichman capacity for critical thinking and the socratic thinking?

Is there a theory of persuasion?

What is the separation between the few the many, the expert?

Arendt, critical thinking and jusdment, her response to the banality of evil

why in the space of appearances the information exchange is not mere deliveration?

What is The nature of Catalyst ?

The political and the social

The exclusion of socio-economic questions from the political, as precondition for broad civic engagement :6

The use of Digital Intelegence

How to organise discussion

[W]e know from experience that no one can adequately grasp the objective world in its full reality all on his own, because the world always shows and reveals itself to him from only one perspective, which corresponds to his standpoint in the world and is determined by it. If someone wants to see and experience the world as it "really" is, he can do so only by understanding it as something that is shared by many people, lies between them, separates and links them. Showing itself differently to each and comprehensible only to the extent that many people can talk about it and exchange their opinions and perspectives with one another,over and against one another. Only in the freedom of our speaking with one another does the world, as that about which we speak, emerge in its objectivity from all sides. Living in a real world and speaking with one another about it are basically one and the same…: 78

This section should focus in the intention that should be achieved and how information moves in the decition making. This aims to be different from traditional representative democracy

"When Arendt links the public space with the space of appearances, as she often does, she primarily has in mind a model of face-to-face human interactions."

Arendt, "Introduction into Politics," 128–129

:201

Hans-Jörg Sigwart, *The Wandering Thought of Hannah Arendt* (London: Palgrave Macmillan, 2016), 54–55.

"frequently emphasizes… spatial implications… she is not always very explicit in *The Human Condition* with regard to the question of how the concrete shape of such political spaces, that is, their institutional organization or their concrete limits and boundaries ought to be perceived."

Seyla Benhabib, *The Reluctant Modernism of Hannah Arendt* (London and New Delhi: Sage, 1996),

Benhabib, *The Reluctant Modernism*, :126–128

Benhabib points out, Arendt uses the term "public sphere" in at least two significantly different senses: one relates directly to the space of appearances, while the other refers more generally to the common world and is obviously broader in its spatial nature.

We have seen that in the context of Palestine as well as in her proposals for federalization in Europe, Arendt was thinking about political institutions that would allow face-to-face interaction, where citizens could meet each other directly, exchange opinions, experience the joy of participation in the public sphere and make decisions about their political affairs. :40

Lederman, Shmuel. (2019). Hannah Arendt and Participatory Democracy: A People's Utopia. 10.1007/978-3-030-11692-7.

What is politeuesthai and doxai?:46

Arendt, "The Great Tradition II," : 947

The importance of the agora, particularly the direct interaction between citizens it makes possible, stems also from the specific kind of speech Arendt has in mind: the expression and exchange of *doxai*, which Arendt interprets as the way the common world is seen from our unique standpoint in it. *Doxa* means both fame and opinion, and these reflect two aspects that are crucial for Arendt: first, the quality of our *doxa* and the way we convey it to others can grant us fame, and similarly, by our *doxa* regarding another person's speech or action we can grant her fame. It is important to stress this possibility—to gain fame not only through great deeds but also through great words—as this is exactly the shift that occurred from kingship to the polis: "polis-life loses opportunities for the truly extraordinary, and its *doxa* therefore becomes more and more an opinion by which the citizen distinguishes himself in the constant activity of *politeuesthai*, and less the shining glory of immortal fame that follows upon great deeds."

Arendt, "The Great Tradition II," 945–946.
Arendt, "Introduction into Politics," 123.Arendt,
"The Great Tradition II," 950.
Arendt, *The Human Condition*, 198.
Arendt, "Introduction into Politics," 124, emphasis added.
Arendt, "Philosophy and Politics: What Is Political Philosophy,"024432.
Lisa J. Disch, ""Please Sit Down, But Don't Make Yourself at Home': Arendtian 'Visiting' and the Prefigurative Politics of ConsciousnessRaising," in *Hannah Arendt and the Meaning of Politics*, ed. Craig Calhoun and John McGowan (Minneapolis and London: University of Minnesota Press, 1997), 153.
Arendt, *The Human Condition*, 178.
Arendt, "The Great Tradition II," 948

What is the public concern?

The exchange of perspectives of the modern world

Second, as our understanding and experience of the world is fundamentally inter-subjective, the exchange of opinions is crucial for our ability to see the world from the point of view of others and so to get a fuller grasp of reality. In "Introduction into Politics," Arendt stresses that achieving the ability to see the world from the others' point of view is dependent upon the actual, close presence of those others: "Since for the Greeks the public political space is common to all… the space where the citizens assemble, it is the realm in which all things can first be recognized in their many-sidedness.":46

Arendt goes on to define the capacity that emerges from this exchange as *phronesis*, and then reiterates the importance of the direct presence of citizens for this capacity to be acquired: "it is important to keep in mind that the freedom of the political man definitely depended on the presence and equality of others. A thing can reveal itself under many aspects only in the presence of peers who regard it from their various perspectives." :46

:167

:169

Arendt, "Introduction into Politics,"

Hannah Arendt, "Karl Jaspers: A Laudatio," in *Men in Dark Times*, 74-78

writes Arendt, "left the proverbial ivory tower of mere contemplation. Thinking becomes practical, though not pragmatic; it is a kind of practice between men, not a performance of one individual in this self-chosen solitude… Philosophy lost both its humility before theology and its arrogance toward the common life of man." This understanding of the meaning of philosophy is based on two presuppositions. The first, already mentioned, is that philosophy and politics are the "existential" concern of everyone. The second is the recognition of the basic condition of human existence: plurality. Truth as communication is a meaningful concept only if we understand truth as manifested differently in different persons, as well as in different nations and cultures. For Arendt, this notion by itself is a new kind of philosophy—not a philosophy of Man, but of mankind. It is unique in that it "insists on the fact that not Man, talking to himself in the dialogue of solitude, but men, talking and communicating with each other, inhabit the earth… it may comprehend politics as one of the great human realms of life as against all former philosophies which, since Plato, thought of the *bios politikos* as an inferior way of life and of politics as a necessary evil. :71

Deliberation as the exchange of dialogue that is pragmatic and inherilty part of human nature because it get closer to reality by pragmatism and the feature of plurality as human nature is

The use of Digital Intelegence

1954 essay, "Concern with Politics in Recent European Philosophical Thought

In the 1954 essay, "Concern with Politics in Recent European Philosophical Thought," Arendt states that Jaspers's concept of truth could lay the ground for a new science of politics. At the same time, she is more critical of Jaspers's concept of communication, which she came to see as modeled on personal relations, rather than on the kind
of intercourse that can take place in the public sphere. Arendt suggests that the ground for overcoming these limits could be found in Heidegger's thought. Heidegger's renunciation of the "arrogance of the absolute," namely the philosopher's claim of privileged proximity to *the* truth, means that "the philosopher has left behind him the claim to being 'wise' and knowing eternal standards for the perishable affairs of the City of men." :71

1954 essay "Philosophy and Politics"

What is freedom ?

The meaning of freedom and public happiness

"Aristotle is the last for whom freedom is not yet 'problematic' but inherent in the faculty of speech; in other words, Aristotle still knew that men, as long as they talk with each other and act together in the *modus* of speech are free.":83

:P289

Hannah Arendt, "Karl Marx and the Tradition of Western Political Thought," *Social Research* 69, no. 2 (2002)

Preface:The gap between past and future

America, France and Hungary had an idea of direct participation and freedom different to the current systems

Introduction into politics: the promise of politics

In the essay "Introduction into Politics," Arendt goes to great lengths to distinguish the Greek understanding of political freedom from other conceptions of freedom.

Arendt, Introduction into politics

Seems that decentralisation is charged with a notion of freedom that has not been pinpoint as the feature that needs to be protected, It is intended to define that

Arendt, "Introduction into Politics," :119

"The crucial point about this kind of political freedom," writes Arendt, "is that it is a spatial construct. Whoever leaves his polis or is banished from it loses not just his hometown or his fatherland; he also loses the only space in which he can be free—and he loses the society of his equals."

As Arendt clarifies also in the essay "Karl Marx and the Tradition of Western Political Thought," *Social Research* 69, no. 2 (2002): :302

Since freedom for the Greeks meant being together with one's equals in the manner of speech and action, there were two preliminary conditions for experiencing this freedom. The first was being a part of a political body where among the citizens no one ruled and no one was being ruled—what the Greeks called *isonomia*. Not being ruled meant that citizens could, in principle, participate in the decision-making process. The second pre-condition for political freedom was being free from necessity, namely, being free from labor and not being confined to the household. However, these are the pre-conditions for freedom, not the actual experience of it :42

What is Arendt's Isonomia?

Here, however, I would like to focus on a posthumously published essay, "The Great Tradition," in which Arendt suggests that there is a more basic distinction that underlies different forms of government. It is not so much who rules over whom, or how many rule and how many are being ruled. Rather, the criterion is the certain way of living-together that each form of government represents. This criterion is reflected in what is considered the main public concern, as well as in the nature of the relationship between those who participate in the public realm.: 43- 44

Meaning of the political For Arendt?

"For, although we merely know, but do not yet really understand, what we are fighting against, we know and understand even less what we are fighting for."

310

What are the implications of lossing the political?

What does involves Arend's idea of humanity?

Hannah Arendt, "Understanding and Politics," in Essays in Understanding, 310

What is positive freedom for Arendt?

On revolution Annah A

The new situation, in which 'humanity' has in effect assumed the role formerly ascribed to nature or history, would mean in this context that the right to have rights, or the right of every individual to belong to humanity, should be guaranteed by humanity itself… it should be understood that this idea transcends the present sphere of international law which still operates in terms of reciprocal agreements between sovereign states… Furthermore, this dilemma would by no means be eliminated by the establishment of a 'world-government'.

The idea of humanity is the recognition that humanity has become a concrete political community, with all the implications and complications involved. To address this challenge, new political principles and political practices must be established: "…human dignity needs a new guarantee which can be found only in a new political principle, in a new law on earth, whose validity this time must comprehend the whole of humanity while its power must remain strictly limited, rooted in and controlled by newly defined territorial entities."

The Human condition

:298

Origins

The Origins, viii, 235–236.

On the idea of humanity and its relation to the federalized structures Arendt advocated, see also Shmuel Lederman, "A Nation Destroyed: An Existential Approach to the Distinctive Harm of Genocide," *Journal of Genocide Research* 19, no. 1 (2017): 112–132

Hannah Arendt, "Organized Guilt and Universal Responsibility," in *Essays in Understanding*, 131; Hannah Arendt, *The Origins of Totalitarianism* (San Diego, New York and London: Harcourt, 1968), 157. See also Lederman, "A Nation Destroyed."

Decentralised systems for its nature should be able to grand certain advantages that the governance of a state cannot since it does not rely on soil as part of the goverment. Then the equivalent to this political rights in decentralised systems should be defined here.

Seyla Benhabib, *The Rights of Others: Aliens, Residents, and Citizens* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2004)

The nation state.... always carried withing itself the seeds of exclusionary injustuce at home and agression abroad :60-61

The formation of power in the council system

At the same time, however, her point is that power emerges from organization—not necessarily in the formal sense, but rather in the sense of the coming together of people and the potential for action that arises from it

Any organization that can generate power can potentially generate violence and other forms of coercion, and this is why power must be checked and balanced by other sources of power.

143–145

Such substitute would not appear, in Arendt's view, as long as "national independence, namely, freedom from foreign rule, and the sovereignty of the state, namely, the claim to unchecked and unlimited power in foreign affairs, are identified."

:107

We find here a remarkable consistency by Arendt from her early to her late reflections on the international order: the principle of sovereignty has to be renounced if the problem of war is to be eliminated or at least mitigated.

On Revolution, Hannah Arendt

When power is accumulted or distributed, this does still vague as how it related to Catalyst as a decentralised system.

On Violence, Hannah Arendt :107

The main cause for wars in our time, Arendt writes in this essay, "is neither a secret death wish of the human species, nor an irrepressible instinct of aggression, nor, finally… the serious economic and social dangers inherent in disarmament, but the simple fact that no substitute for this final arbiter in international affairs has yet appeared on the political scene."

Hannah Arendt, Thoughts on Politics and Revolution :230

there can be no last resort except war; if war no longer serves that purpose, that fact alone proves that we must have a new concept of the state. This new concept of the state, to be sure, will not result from the founding of a new international court that would function better than the one at The Hague, or a new League of Nations, since the same conflicts between sovereign or ostensibly sovereign governments can only be played out there all over again…
The mere rudiments I see for a new state concept can be found in the federal system, whose advantage is that power moves neither from above nor from below, but is horizontally directed so that the federated units *mutually check and control their powers*.

The Human condition

Power is not force or strength; it is not a capability of a single person, but an ability that grows from within a group, between persons who speak and act together, and it disappears once these people are separated: "While strength is the natural quality of an individual seen in isolation, power springs up between men when they act together and vanishes the moment they disperse."

Decentralisation and revolutions in history US, French, Hungarian

When centralisation and dencetralisation are preferable?

Did Europe in WWII fought for a decentralised power system ?

The problems

What is Arendt's concept of modernity? And why she sees modernity as a problem ?

Conventional studies

"There can only be real democracy when decentralisation of power in the nation -state has been broken, and replaced with a diffusion of power into the many power centers of a federal system"

"The larger political needs of our civilisation. with its 'growing unity" in one side and its growing national counsciousness of the people in the other, would be meet with the idea of federation"

:210

"this sudden uprising of an oppressed people for the sake of freedom and hardly anything else… then we had the privilege to witness it."

:18

What is the political from the Polis of the Greeks that Arendt returns to ?

Sophocles and the polis

Arendt, On revolution

Arendt. The Human Condition

Hannah Arendt. Nation-state democracy in thinking without a banister ed jerome khon 2018:261

This revision intends to find the mistakes made in history, the potential path dependace to avoid and main justifications from the Arendtian philosophy.

Hannah Arendt, the nation

Arendt, "Totalitarian Imperialism,"

It was specifically the re-appearance of the councils—"the same organization which for more than a hundred years now has emerged whenever the people have been permitted for a few days, or a few weeks or months, to follow their own political devices without a government (or a party program) imposed from above"—that Arendt saw as signifying more than anything else this yearning for freedom.

Lars Rensmann, "Grounding Cosmopolitans: Rethinking Crimes Against Humanity and Global Political Theory with Arendt and Adorno," in *Arendt and Adorno: Political and Philosophical Investigations*, ed. Lars Rensmann and Samir Gandesha (Stanford: Stanford University Press, 2012), :146

Lars Rensmann has argued that "Arendt's bottom-up understanding of associational politics is not limited to territorial borders… If grounded in bottom-up associations and struggles, transnational communities in action may help engender cosmopolitan advocacy for human dignity and freedom 'at home'"

In Herzog's and Rensmann's reading, then, the Arendtian space of appearances does not require direct, face-to-face interaction; it can be created between people who do not even live on the same continent

:40

Lederman, Shmuel. (2019). Hannah Arendt and Participatory Democracy: A People's Utopia. 10.1007/978-3-030-11692-7.

The minimum imperative for the structure of a decentralised system

Identification of the units of the system

How the townhall would look like?

It must certainlly be in the constitution as the only inalianable mechanism in which a citizen-participant can be free

Yet the notion of Citizen already denote more rights over a subclass categorisation

Is the public sphere only for representatives or for anyone?

These should result in the minimun expresions but indispensable that a decentralised system should have given that its nature is different to the traditional democracies.

From centralised nation state to transformed federalisation of political structures between and within states

"Arendt, refers here to the fact that the European resistance demanded, in the words of one prominent historian " Decentralisation within national states, with more power placed in the hands of selfgoverning local communities of manageable size":13

"A political principle that which would prevent nations from developing nationalism and would thereby lay the fundamentals of an international community, capable of presenting and protecting the civilisation of the modern world"

advantages

Arendt suggested not only an alternative conception of philosophy, politics, and the relationship between them, but also a modern *isonomy* whose very pre-supposition is this new kind of relationship: the council system.

-The no need of land argument
-Decentralisation as precondition for collective decition making
- Transparency
- Frictionless participation
- Memory
- Problem solving
-Effectiveness

ETC

The need for the preservation of memory! Self distinction and the organise remembrance of the polis : 58-59

Walter Lippens, A history of European Integration, vol 1 the formation of the european unity movement :48

Otto Bauer, "Two Revolutions," in *Austro-Marxism*, trans. and ed. Tom Bottomore and Patrick Goode (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1978), 159.

What is a precice definition of the concil system ?

The CS is a "Arendt sought an alternative concenption of the meaning of philosophy, politics, and the relationships between them, which could serve as a theoretical foundation for a new form of goverment based on equality, rather than on relations of rule. The council system was in arendts mind, precisely this kind of goverment" :5

The work' councils are still in their infancy. The revolution was able to establish them, but their development requires time and experience; only through gradual development, a gradual self-education in the practice of works' council activity, will the workers be able to produce from their own ranks a staff of trained representatives able to take full advantage of the new institution… their creation and development is a more important preparation for a socialist system of society than any forcible act of expropriation…

Forgiveness as part of the system

What is the role of philosophy and politics in the councils :90-96

Jeffrey C. Isaac, *Arendt, Camus, and Modern Rebellion* (New Haven: Yale University Press, 1992), 151. See also Isaac's essay, "A New Guarantee on Earth: Hannah Arendt on Human Dignity and the Politics of Human Rights," *American Political Science Review* 90, no. 1 (1996) : 61–73.

"The council system thus represents a promising alternative to the system of sovereign states and seems to harbor the possibility of embedding human rights in a new framework of meaningful and pluralistic political communities."